**PROJECT COST**

**₹1.08**
**lakh crore**

**TOTAL LENGTH**

**508**
**kilometre**

**TOTAL STATIONS**

**12**

Gujarat, straight like an arrow through various villages and towns where extensive industrial and urban development is planned to take advantage of their rapid connectivity to India's commercial capital Mumbai. Besides land acquisition, NHSRCL has awarded all civil contracts in Gujarat and Maharashtra (where a 156-km corridor is coming up), a major step towards reducing the rail travel time between the two terminal hubs from the current 5-7 hours to just over two hours (see *Progress Report*).

Located in the heart of the Ahmedabad-Gandhinagar urban agglomeration, massive concourses are under construction at the Sabarmati Multimodal Transport Hub—home to the terminal bullet train station in Gujarat. The NHSRCL public relations officer in Ahmedabad draws up an oral vision of how these concourses will turn into busy streets in four years, with commuters hopping on and off the bullet train to seamlessly catch a regular train to onward destinations, or the Ahmedabad Metro connecting to state capital Gandhinagar, or the local bus rapid transit system. Lined with premium hotels, restaurants, office spaces and shopping plazas, the hub will rival any major airport in India. In Mumbai, the terminal HSR station is being constructed underground at the upscale Bandra Kurla Complex.

Based on the Shinkansen bullet trains, first introduced in Japan in 1964, the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed Rail (MAHSR) project is estimated to cost Rs 1.08 lakh crore. A soft loan extended by the Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) will help fund 81 per cent of the construction cost, the



**CONCRETE STEPS**
Concourses being built at the Sabarmati Multimodal Transport Hub